Kevin Trayner

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Summary

Product & Strategic Design Leader with 20+ years driving experience architecture, design governance, and customer-centric strategies for Fortune 100 enterprise ecosystems. Proven track record translating complex business models into seamless digital products that scale to 30M+ users. Expert at bridging CX, product, and executive stakeholders to accelerate time-to-market, reduce friction, and increase revenue.

Core Competencies

- **Design & Strategy:** Product Design | Experience Architecture | Service Design | Design Systems and Governance | Journey Mapping.
- **Leadership & Execution:** Cross-Functional Team Leadership | Agile/SDLC | Friction Audits | Stakeholder Alignment | Design Mentorship.
- **Tools & Artifacts:** Figma Component Libraries | Wireframing & Prototyping | Generative AI for UX (Gemini | Claude Code | Copilot) How I use AI in projects.

Relevant Work Experience

- **Define a long-term design vision for a new service:** Shaped the customer experience strategy for Verizon's Satellite to Device capability to close coverage dead zones and support a beta launch.
  Case Study: Create a design strategy and journey map for a new Satellite service
- **Work from high level vision to detail design experience across multiple channels, products and teams:** Led cross-functional teams spanning Product, CX, Development, Research, Marketing, and Legal to deliver high-impact digital experiences from initial discovery and research through final production.
  Case Study: Build an end to end experience across channels, functions and business units for FCC labels.
- **Use customer insights, prototyping and iteration to incrementally improve, then revamp our mobile plans architecture:** Take customer research and data to develop multiple design concepts, iterate and test, and ultimately create a new product to differentiate Verizon in the market.
  Case Study: Address current friction points in our mobile plans today. Identify opportunities for future direction of mobile plans to distinguish Verizon from the competition.

- **Collaborate with multiple teams and align stakeholders to solve for ambiguity:** In collaboration with stakeholders across teams, defined end-to-end design vision in ambiguous product spaces using compelling storytelling, research, and prototyping;

driving consensus with executive stakeholders and third-party partners. *Case Study: Netflix and Max.Own and define the end-to-end experience, and remove ambiguity for a new streaming launch*

- **Mentoring teams, identifying design system patterns, and evolving our ways of working:** Mentor junior designers within the design organization; meet weekly with the VDS (Verizon Design System) to identify future patterns based on project work and future needs, give feedback and critique on the work of other designers; all toward evolving our ways of working and processes in the broader design organization.
- **Incorporate AI into design work:** Use agentic and generative AI (Gemini, Claude Code, Copilot, Figma Make) strategically to make work flow better - brief creation, journey mapping, prototyping, research, and more - but keep the human in the lead. Examples of how I use AI in projects.

Professional Experience

Verizon Consumer Group (VCG) - Basking Ridge, NJ

Lead design strategist/designer on VCG Design team for Mobile and other digital products.

Principal Experience Designer / Architect (2024 – Present)

- **Define Experience Vision:** Lead end-to-end design strategy for mobile products, turning complex business rules into simple digital journeys for customers.
- **Design system & process governance:** Created reusable Figma templates and guidance to help the team launch new promotions faster.
- **Partner with research and other teams to influence strategic direction:** Address current friction points in our mobile plans today, and identify opportunities for future direction of mobile plans to distinguish Verizon from the competition.
- **Cross-functional alignment & stakeholder leadership:** Led collaborative workshops with business, product, and design leaders to solve technical issues and align cross-channel strategies.
- **Mentorship & practice development:** Mentored junior and mid-level designers on design skills, system thinking, and presentations - to foster a design-led culture.

Lead Experience Designer (2021 – 2024)

- **Flagship product strategy (myPlans):** Redesigned the main "myPlan" offerings to simplify customer choices and encourage higher-value plans. Smoothed out friction and increased conversion for customers adding a line, by clearly indicating the low cost of adding a 3rd line, adding $8.4M/mo in revenue.
- **Own end-to-end experience for new streaming launch:** Launched a new streaming combo service (Netflix/Max) that fit the existing service model, satisfied our partners, and removed ambiguity for customers. Remains Verizon's second-best-selling perk, on nearly 11 million mobile accounts.
- **Modernized product experience to increase sales:** Led CX updates for connected device plans (tablets and smartwatches), directly contributing to tablet premium plan activations performing 3.3% above forecast.
- **Cross functional, cross-channel, cross-business unit product label experience:** Spearheaded the UX design and cross-platform implementation for FCC-mandated

product labels across all mobile and home services, meeting legal requirements without negatively impacting the plans experience.

Senior UX Designer (2016 – 2021)

- Optimized the Learn & Buy sales funnel on Verizon.com, enhancing web and mobile journeys for 32M+ active users.
- Delivered high-fidelity wireframes, interactive prototypes, and user flows in close collaboration with development and brand teams.

Deloitte Touche Tohmatsu - Princeton, NJ

Lead designer/business analyst of internal systems for the largest professional services firm worldwide, used by 15,00 audit and assurance professionals worldwide.

Senior Business Analyst/Designer (2010 – 2016)

- Managed user requirements and experience design for internal software used by 80,000 professionals across 32 countries.
- Facilitated regular usability and UAT sessions with real users to validate core features against technical constraints.

User Experience Designer (2004 – 2010)

- Designed enterprise web/desktop applications, delivering wireframes, process flows, site maps, and UI pattern libraries.
- Wrote comprehensive user guides and support materials to help employees worldwide adopt new software.

Multimedia Specialist (2001 – 2004)

- Developed interactive product demos and visual prototypes to support global software rollouts.

Technical Writer (1995 – 2001)

- Authored user documentation and help guides for desktop applications serving 20,000 global users.

Additional Experience (pre- 2000s)

Instructional Designer - Eduneering
Small, start up tech consulting firm, specializing in regulatory training for energy, food manufacturing and pharma industries. (Owned by UL Solutions today).

- Designed interactive computer-based training modules for Fortune 500 clients in the energy and telecommunications industries.

Editor - Cranbury Publications

- Managed production, design, and writing staff for local newspapers and oversaw the startup of a new publication.

Certifications & Education

• **Google AI Professional Certificate** — Coursera / Google (2026)
• **Generative AI for UX Design & Prototyping** (Gemini, Claude Code, Copilot, Figma)
• **BA in English / Communications** — Ursinus College, Collegeville, PA

Leadership and Publications

• **Board of Trustees** — Murray Grove Retreat Center, Lanoka Harbor, NJ. Provide oversight, strategic direction, and governance for a 20 acre retreat focused on radical hospitality.
• **Published Author & Columnist** — Author of *Beer Drinker's Handbook* | Columnist for Ale Street News.